

Purpose: To encourage us to develop the characteristics of true followers of Jesus Christ.

“Admonition of Paul,”—[Philippians 4:8](#) and [13th Article of Faith](#)

1. Paul encourages the Philippian Saints to follow Jesus Christ.

- Read [Philippians](#).
 - Philippians 1:12-18. Paul’s bondage in Rome worked to “the furtherance of the gospel”.
 - Philippians 2:2-3. Having “the same love ... Let ... each esteem other better than themselves.”
- In what ways should members be “of one mind”? (See Philippians 1:27; 2:14-15.)
- Why do we sometimes do things for “vainglory”? †1. Beware of Pride
- Why is it important that we not think we are better than other people? (See [D&C 38:24-26](#).)
- Philippians 2:5-8. “Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus ... But made himself of no reputation”.
- How did Jesus set the perfect example of being humble and submissive to His Father? (See John 8:29.)
- How can we become more humble and submissive to Heavenly Father’s will?
- Philippians 2:12. Work “out your own salvation with fear and trembling.” †2. President David O. McKay
 - Philippians 4:4. “Rejoice in the Lord always: and again I say, Rejoice.”
 - Philippians 3:7-8. “But what things were gain to me, those I counted loss for Christ.”
- Why is it important that we make sacrifices for Christ? †3. Joseph Smith
- Philippians 4:6-8. In “every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving”.
- How can we obtain the “peace of God” in verse 7? How can we apply Paul’s Admonition in verse 8?
- Philippians 4:13. “I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me”.

2. Paul reminds the Colossians that redemption comes only through Christ.

- Read [Colossians 1](#).
- “Saints in Colosse, a small city east of Ephesus, were being influenced by teachings that minimized the importance of the Savior and focused on gaining perfection by observing ordinances and worshiping angels.” (*Lesson Manual*)
- What truths about Jesus Christ did Paul teach the Colossians? (See Colossians 1:12-22.)
- How does your knowledge and testimony of Jesus Christ affect the way you live?
- Colossians 1:23. “If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled”.
- What does it mean to be “grounded and settled” in the gospel?
- What can we do to strengthen our testimonies?

3. Paul teaches the Colossians what they should do as the elect of God.

- Read [Colossians 2:1-8, 16-23](#); [Colossians 3](#); [Colossians 4](#).
 - Colossians 2:2-3. “That their hearts might be comforted, being knit together in love”.
 - Colossians 2:7. “Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, ... abounding therein with thanksgiving.”
- How can we become rooted in Christ?
- Colossians 2:8. “Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy ... after the tradition of men”. (Enrichment †13.)
 - Colossians 3:12-15. “Put on therefore ... mercies, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, longsuffering”.
- How can we more fully develop these attributes?
- Colossians 3:16-17. “Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom ... [and] in psalms and hymns”.
- How can we make better use of hymns and other sacred music? †4. Elder Dallin H. Oaks
- Colossians 3:15, 17. “And whatsoever ye do ... do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God”.
- Why is it important that we be thankful? †5. D. Lynn Ford

4. Paul encourages Philemon to be forgiving toward Onesimus.

- Read [Philemon](#). “Paul wrote a personal letter to Philemon, a member of the Church in Colosse, regarding Philemon’s slave Onesimus. Onesimus had robbed Philemon and run away to Rome, where he met Paul and was converted to the Church. Paul asked Philemon to forgive Onesimus and accept him as a brother in the gospel.” (*Lesson Manual*)
- What can we learn from this about the gospel’s power to transform human relationships? (See Philemon 16.)
- Philemon 18. “If he hath wronged thee, or oweth thee ought, put that on mine account”
- How does the gospel affect your relationships with the people around you.

Next Week: L41 “I Have Finished My Course”; See L41: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NT40 Quotes

†1. **Beware of Pride:** “Pride is a very misunderstood sin, and many are sinning in ignorance. (See Mosiah 3:11; 3 Ne. 6:18.) In the scriptures there is no such thing as righteous pride—it is always considered a sin...

“Most of us think of pride as self-centeredness, conceit, boastfulness, arrogance, or haughtiness. All of these are elements of the sin, but the heart, or core, is still missing.

“The central feature of pride is enmity—enmity toward God and enmity toward our fellowmen. Enmity means ‘hatred toward, hostility to, or a state of opposition.’ It is the power by which Satan wishes to reign over us.

“Pride is essentially competitive in nature. We pit our will against God’s. When we direct our pride toward God, it is in the spirit of ‘my will and not thine be done.’ As Paul said, they ‘seek their own, not the things which are Jesus Christ’s.’ (Philip. 2:21.)

“Another major portion of this very prevalent sin of pride is enmity toward our fellowmen. We are tempted daily to elevate ourselves above others and diminish them. (See Hel. 6:17; D&C 58:41.)

“The proud make every man their adversary by pitting their intellects, opinions, works, wealth, talents, or any other worldly measuring device against others. In the words of C. S. Lewis: ‘Pride gets no pleasure out of having something, only out of having more of it than the next man. ... It is the comparison that makes you proud: the pleasure of being above the rest. Once the element of competition has gone, pride has gone.’ (Mere Christianity, New York: Macmillan, 1952, pp. 109–10.)” (President Ezra Taft Benson, “[Beware of Pride](#),” *Ensign*, May 1989)

†2. **President David O. McKay:** “‘Work out your own salvation’ is an exhortation to demonstrate by activity, by thoughtful, obedient effort the reality of faith. But this must be done with a consciousness that absolute dependence upon self may produce pride and weakness that will bring failure. With ‘fear and trembling’ we should seek the strength and grace of God for inspiration to obtain the final victory” (in Conference Report, Apr. 1957, 7).

†3. **Joseph Smith:** “A religion that does not require the sacrifice of all things never has power sufficient to produce the faith necessary unto life and salvation; for, from the first existence of man, the faith necessary unto the enjoyment of life and salvation never could be obtained without the sacrifice of all earthly things” (*Lectures on Faith* [1985], 69).

†4. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “We need to make more use of our hymns to put us in tune with the Spirit of the Lord, to unify us, and to help us teach and learn our doctrine. We need to make better use of our hymns in

missionary teaching, in gospel classes, in quorum meetings, in home evenings, and in home teaching visits. Music is an effective way to worship our Heavenly Father and his Son, Jesus Christ. We should use hymns when we need spiritual strength and inspiration” (“[Worship Through Music](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 12).

†5. **D. Lynn Ford:** “In my prayers each morning, I thanked my Heavenly Father for many things, from the gift of Christ’s atonement to the flowers in my yard. I felt awkward for the first few days, thinking at times, *Who am I, with all my problems, to think I should be extolling our Father’s goodness? He is already great and perfect, so why should he desire the thanks and feeble devotions of a child like me who is so far from reaching her own potential?*

“Yet, as I continued my prayers, I discovered a new truth—that such heartfelt devotions to the Most High are actually for our own good. He has no need for our honors, but our sincere gratitude and devotions to him help us in important ways as we strive for perfection in our own lives.

“I learned that we tend to emulate those whom we admire. If we take time daily to ponder God’s greatness, we are more likely to strive to be like him, more likely to repent and become “partakers of the divine nature” (2 Pet. 1:4). Gradually, I began to enjoy feasting on the scriptures to learn more of our Father and our Savior...” (“[In Praise of God](#),” *Ensign*, October 1995)

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT40 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 45: Philippians and Colossians](#).
3. President Ezra Taft Benson, “[Beware of Pride](#),” *Ensign*, May 1989.
4. Elder Dallin H. Oaks, (“[Worship Through Music](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 12.
5. D. Lynn Ford, “[In Praise of God](#),” *Ensign*, October 1995.

Visit stephenmbird.com